

Europe's first solar flowers?

The Government's claims about Gozo's fifteen solar flowers, tested against the record

THE CLAIM

“With the installation of these first solar flowers in Europe, we are demonstrating ...”

Clint Camilleri, Minister for Gozo and Planning, 21 October 2025

Lovin Malta's English of his quoted words (Maltese original: TVM News). The Commission's page says the same.

He added the energy would supply the Park and Ride's electric buses.

VERDICT

CONTRADICTED

In service elsewhere in Europe from 2015.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

2016

Austria had one first

Motorway operator ASFINAG put a SmartFlower into service at a rest area on the A21.

15

SmartFlowers installed

The maker calls Gozo's "one of the largest installations in Europe", not the first.

≈85 MWh

Modelled output a year

PVGIS, if 2.5 kWp each: 36% more than fixed panels. No metered output published.

2–3 h

Of shuttle service a day

What that output equals at bus consumption from other studies. Indicative only.

None

Energy balance published

No output or bus-use figures found; Parliament was told no feasibility study was made (Newsbook).

FAIR TO SAY

The flowers work, were EU-funded at about €850,000 and seem to be Malta's first. A claim to be among Europe's largest would have held.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ What "first of its kind in Europe" meant.

☐ The flowers' capacity and metered output.

☐ The shuttle buses' charging energy and hours.

☐ How the flowers are wired to the chargers.